



LEEDS
INTERNATIONAL
SCHOOL

Social Media Usage Policy

Policy Title	: Social Media Policy
Document Number	: LEIS/PCY/OPS/HRM/001
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Policy Approval Date	: 25/03/2025
Policy Effective Date	: 26/03/2025
To be implemented by	: All the Branches, Academic and Non-Academic Departments of LEEDS International School Network
Related Documents	: Code of Ethics and Staff Manual for Teachers And Child Protection and Safeguarding Policy

1. INTRODUCTION AND PURPOSE

This policy provides guidelines for the appropriate use of social media by all academic and non-academic staff members of LEEDS International School. It aims to protect the school's reputation, maintain professionalism, ensure student privacy, and safeguard the well-being of all stakeholders in our educational community.

Social media offers valuable opportunities for communication, networking, and educational engagement. However, it also presents risks to privacy, professional boundaries, and institutional reputation. This policy establishes clear expectations to help staff navigate these challenges responsibly.

2. SCOPE

This policy applies to all employees of LEEDS International School, including:

- a) School management
- b) Administrative staff
- c) Support staff
- d) Teachers and teaching assistants
- e) Contract employees and temporary staff

The policy governs social media activity that may impact the school, whether conducted during work hours or personal time, using school resources or personal devices.

3. DEFINITION OF SOCIAL MEDIA

For the purposes of this policy, the term "social media" refers to any digital platform that allows users to create and share content or participate in social networking. This includes, but is not limited to:

- | | |
|-------------------------|-----------|
| a) Facebook | l) Rumble |
| b) Instagram | m) Reddit |
| c) Tik-Tok | n) WeChat |
| d) YouTube | o) Bigo |
| e) Pinterest | |
| f) X (Formerly Twitter) | |
| g) LinkedIn | |
| h) WhatsApp | |
| i) Telegram | |
| j) Viber | |
| k) Discord | |

4. PRIVACY SETTINGS MANAGEMENT

All staff members must take responsibility for managing their privacy settings across social media platforms:

- 4.1. Regularly review and update privacy settings to ensure personal information is protected.
- 4.2. Configure settings so that personal information, posts, and photos are visible only to trusted connections and not to the public.
- 4.3. Restrict access to educational qualifications, workplace information, and contact details.
- 4.4. Conduct periodic audits of who can view your profile and content using the privacy check tools available on most platforms.
- 4.5. Be aware that privacy settings can change when platforms update, requiring regular verification.

5. Content Publishing Guidelines

5.1. Professional Conduct

- a) Maintain a professional tone and demeanor in all online communications.
- b) Consider how any post might be interpreted by students, parents, colleagues, or the wider community before publishing.
- c) Avoid sharing content that could be deemed controversial, inappropriate, or unprofessional.

5.2. School Representation

- a) Staff members who list LEEDS International School as their employer must exercise heightened caution regarding political ideas, religion, race, or other potentially divisive topics.
- b) All opinions expressed remain the personal responsibility of the staff member and should never be presented as representing the views of LEEDS International School.
- c) Staff members must maintain professional profile images on all social media accounts that interact with parents or school management.
- d) Staff members must use their full name when engaging in official correspondence or using official social media platforms related to school communications. i.e. : First Name (Calling Name) + Second Name

e.g. John Smith not as J.Smith

5.3. Prohibited Content

- a) Staff members identifying themselves as LEEDS International School employees must not engage in discriminatory discussions related to protected characteristics including age, race, religion, disability, gender, and maternity.

- b) Staff listing the school's name in their profiles must not post, comment on, or share content related to pornography, alcohol, drugs, or content inappropriate for minors according to Sri Lankan cultural standards.
- c) Posting unwanted memes, posts, or content targeting team members, management, or the school to ridicule, embarrass, or humiliate will not be tolerated.
- d) Staff members should not publish individual or group photos of students on social media and should not take pictures/ videos or content during school hours.

6. SCHOOL IDENTITY PROTECTION

6.1. Staff members must not:

- a) Wearing school ID badges or official LEEDS International School uniforms/t-shirts in personal photos or videos published on social media when participating in personal activities such as family gatherings, private celebrations, personal trips, or other non-school events. However, this limitation does not apply to school-authorized events, official school gatherings, or any school-sponsored activities where staff representation is appropriate and expected
- b) Capture or share photographs or videos of school premises, buildings, grounds, facilities, or any identifiable elements of the school on any personal social media platform without proper authorization from school administration.
- c) Post photographs, videos, live streams, or any visual content on personal social media platforms that show students in school uniforms or school activities without explicit prior authorization. This includes all forms of media sharing such as posts, stories, reels, and live broadcasts. All authorized content must comply with the school's child protection policies and have appropriate parental consent
- d) Use the school's name, logo, student images, or any LEEDS International School brand elements for personal promotion, commercial gain, or non-authorized purposes on any platform.

6.2. Staff members are prohibited from taking part in or posting derogatory photographs and videos on personal social media while at work, or while wearing company garments inside/outside school premises with intent to damage the reputation of the school.

6.3. **However, representing and promoting the school through personal social media platforms in a manner that brings a positive light to the institution is encouraged.**

7. ACCOUNT MANAGEMENT

7.1. Staff members must not:

- a) Create or maintain any social media account, page, or group under the name of LEEDS International School without explicit written authorization from school management.

- b) Post any content, opinions, or comments that might bring negativity or harm to the school, its employees, or activities.

7.2. Staff members are prohibited from:

- a) Creating, encouraging, or participating in private groups with stakeholders (particularly parents) intended to express or share negative ideas about the school.
- b) Sharing harmful thoughts about the school and its activities in any online forum.

8. RELATIONSHIP MANAGEMENT

8.1. Professional Boundaries

- a) Do not accept friend or follow requests from current students on personal social media accounts.
- b) Exercise caution when considering connection requests from parents of students.
- c) Direct students and parents to official school communication channels for all school-related matters.
- d) Maintain clear professional boundaries in all online interactions with school stakeholders.

8.2. Workplace Relationships

- a) Special consideration applies to employees in romantic relationships with coworkers. Such relationships must not result in behavior or online activity that causes problems, intimidation, or embarrassment to colleagues or damage to the school's reputation.
- b) Threatening, stalking, or sharing misinformation, gossip, or rumors intended to harm a coworker through any personal social media platform is strictly prohibited, especially in cases of relationship breakups, personal grudges, or jealousy.

9. INTELLECTUAL PROPERTY RIGHTS

9.1. Company Intellectual Property

- a) Employees must refrain from unauthorized use of school copyrighted materials, trademarks, logos, and proprietary content.
- b) This includes not reproducing, distributing, or modifying school-owned content without proper authorization.
- c) School branding materials must not be used in a manner inconsistent with school guidelines or without obtaining prior approval.

10. PERSONAL USAGE OF SOCIAL MEDIA DURING WORK HOURS

- 10.1. It is prohibited to use social media during work hours unless during designated breaks, and school-owned devices or accounts must never be used for personal social media activities.

11. POSITIVE ENGAGEMENT GUIDELINES

- 11.1. Staff members are encouraged to:

- a) Share and promote content published on the school's official social media platforms in a manner that fosters positive attitudes toward the school and its activities.
- b) Engage with official school content in a professional and supportive manner that reflects well on our educational community.
- c) Consider how interactions with school-related content might be perceived by others within and outside our community.

12. DISCIPLINARY CONSEQUENCES

- 12.1. If an employee or group of employees violates this policy due to negligence:

- a) Following an initial verbal warning, the HR Department will issue up to two formal written warnings to staff members who violate this policy. Each warning will document the specific violation and required corrective action
- b) Such actions will only be taken after concluding an impartial disciplinary hearing where each party has a fair opportunity to express their concerns.

- 12.2. More serious violations may result in higher disciplinary actions, including termination of employment, if:

- a) The team member fails to adhere after 2 written warnings after the first verbal warning
- b) A team member has violated policy conditions with malicious intent
- c) An employee has intentionally violated conditions due to influence or monetary gains provided by a competitor
- d) An employee has intentionally caused irreparable damage to the LEEDS brand name or intellectual properties

- 12.3. The disciplinary process will be conducted in accordance with school policies and applicable employment laws.

13. POLICY REVIEW

This social media policy will be subject to periodic review as needed to adapt to evolving technologies, changing social media platforms, and emerging best practices in educational settings. The school administration will promptly notify all staff members of any modifications or updates to this policy through official communication channels

14. ACKNOWLEDGMENT

All staff members must acknowledge that they have read, understood, and agree to abide by this social media policy by signing and returning the acknowledgment form to the Human Resources department.

16. POLICY REVIEW & APPROVAL

Prepared By		Reviewed By	
			
Mr. Binishka Nayananda General Manager Operations		Ms. Kaushalya Illeperuma Coordinating Principal	
Approved By	Approved By	Approved By	
			
Mr. Thilina Diyagama Director	Ms. Kinithi Jayathissa Directress	Ms. Malithi Jayathissa Deputy Chairperson	

CERTIFICATE *of* SIGNATURE

REF. NUMBER
OVVR5-SAGVJ-3RKSV-QTYC3

DOCUMENT COMPLETED BY ALL PARTIES ON
27 MAR 2025 02:05:43 UTC

SIGNER

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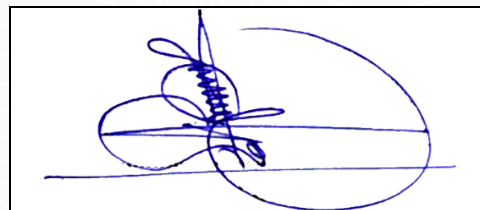
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SIGNATURE



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DEHIWALA, SRI LANKA

RECIPIENT VERIFICATION

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MALITHI JAYATISSA

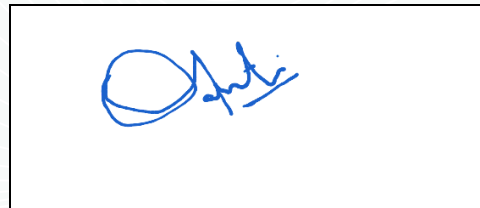
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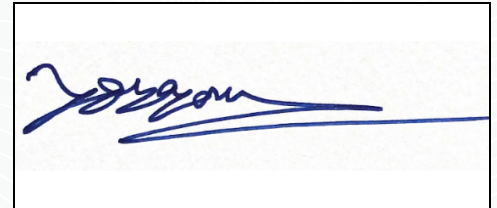
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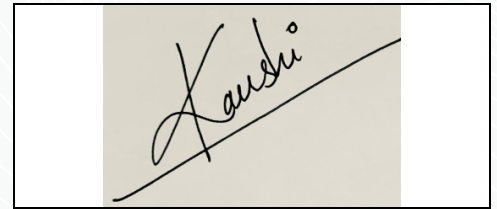
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